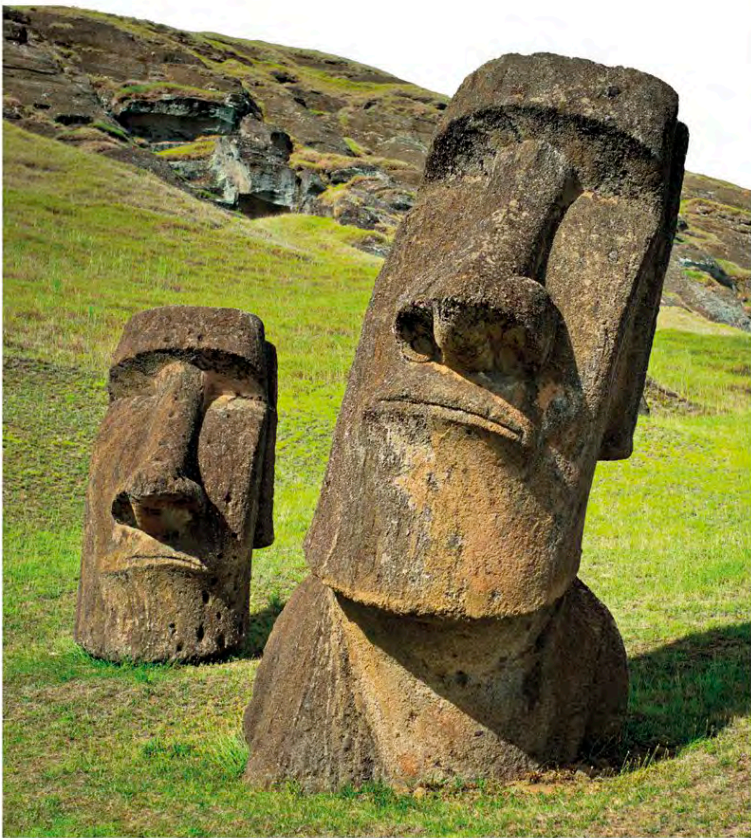
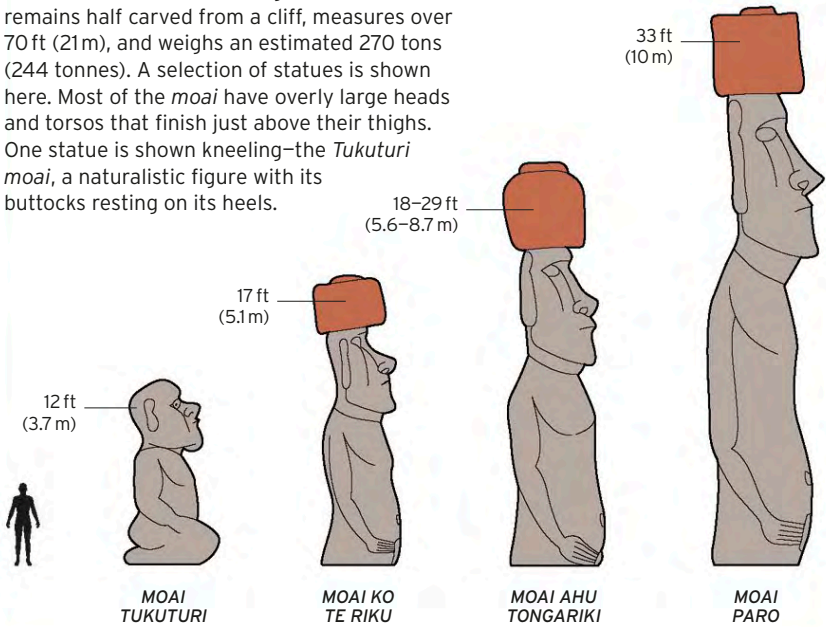




GIANTS OF THE PACIFIC

The Rapa Nui *moai* range in height from 6½ ft (2 m) to more than 33 ft (10 m). Among the erected *moai*, the heaviest stands at *Ahu Tongariki* and weighs 95 tons (86 tonnes). The largest unfinished *moai* remains half carved from a cliff, measures over 70 ft (21 m), and weighs an estimated 270 tons (244 tonnes). A selection of statues is shown here. Most of the *moai* have overly large heads and torsos that finish just above their thighs. One statue is shown kneeling—the *Tukuturi moai*, a naturalistic figure with its buttocks resting on its heels.



△ MOAI FACTORY

At the *Rano Raraku* quarry, nearly 900 *moai* were carved from tuff, a porous rock formed by volcanic ash. The examples seen here lack the headdresses made of red scoria stone found on some *moai*.

▽ STONE FACED

Ahu Tongariki is the largest ceremonial structure on Easter Island. Its 15 statues stand on a 330-ft- (100-m-) long platform, their backs to the sea, protecting the ancient village that once stood before them.

The giant stone statues at Easter Island weigh an **average** of **14 tons (13 tonnes)**

